

Marksman Setup Guide

Installing and running Marksman on Windows

Windows 10 and 11 · No administrator rights needed · About 10 minutes

Marksman stops your computer going to sleep. It nudges your mouse pointer every so often, and it also asks Windows directly to keep the screen on, which is the part most similar tools get wrong.

Nothing is installed on your PC. Everything sits in one folder, so if you decide you don't want it, you delete the folder and it's gone. That's also why you don't need admin rights on your machine.

You'll download two things: a portable copy of Python, which is what Marksman runs on, and Marksman itself. Work through the steps in order. Step 2 looks unnecessary but it prevents a run of confusing security pop-ups later, so please don't skip it.

PART ONE / SETUP, DONE ONCE

1 Download the Python bundle

Go to the WinPython releases page:

| <https://github.com/winpython/winpython/releases>

It lists a lot of files. Scroll down and find the one named WinPython64-3.13.15.1dotb1.zip and click it. It's about 27 MB.

Watch out. *There are near-identical names on that page. You want the one ending in .zip, not .exe.*

2 Unblock the ZIP before you open it

DO THIS BEFORE UNPACKING

Windows quietly flags files that came from the internet. If you unpack first, that flag gets copied onto every file inside, and you'll be dismissing security warnings for the rest of the setup. Clearing it now takes five seconds and saves all of that.

1. Right-click the ZIP file you just downloaded
2. Choose **Properties**
3. At the bottom of that window, tick **Unblock**
4. Click **OK**

No Unblock box? *Then Windows already trusts the file. Carry on.*

3 Unpack it

Right-click the ZIP, choose **Extract All**, then **Extract**.

You'll get a folder called WinPython64-3.13.15.1dotb1. Open it and you'll find another folder inside named something like WPy64-313151.

Keep that inner folder in mind. It holds a folder called python, and you'll need to come back to it in step 6.

4 Download Marksman

| <https://github.com/janjocefjuan/mouse-mover>

On that page click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.

5 Unblock and unpack Marksman too

Exactly as in step 2: right-click the ZIP, **Properties**, tick **Unblock**, **OK**. Then right-click, **Extract All**, **Extract**.

6 Move Marksman next to Python

This is the step people get wrong, so go slowly.

Look through the folders you just unpacked and find the one that **directly contains a file called** Setup.bat. Drag that whole folder into the WPy64-313151 folder from step 3.

When you're finished, opening WPy64-313151 should show the python folder and your Marksman folder sitting side by side.

Why it matters. Marksman locates Python by looking at the folders around it. Keep the two together and it sorts itself out.

7 Run Setup, once

Inside your Marksman folder, double-click Setup.bat.

A black window opens and fetches the few extra pieces Marksman needs. Wait for it to say **Setup complete**, then press any key to close it. Give it a minute or two.

If a blue box appears. Where it says "Windows protected your PC", click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. You get this because Marksman doesn't come from a large software company, not because there's anything wrong with it.

8 Make the Desktop icon

In the same folder, double-click Install Marksman Shortcut.vbs. A small box tells you it's done.

You now have a **Marksman** icon on your Desktop, and it will also come up if you type "Marksman" into the Start menu. Setup is finished, and you won't need to open these folders again.

PART TWO / USING IT

Starting it

Double-click Marksman, then press **Start**. The dot at the bottom turns green and reads "Running". Your computer will now stay awake.

Jiggle or Random

Jiggle shifts the pointer two pixels and puts it straight back, which you will hardly ever notice. Random throws the pointer to a new spot on the screen each time. Jiggle is the one you want.

Interval

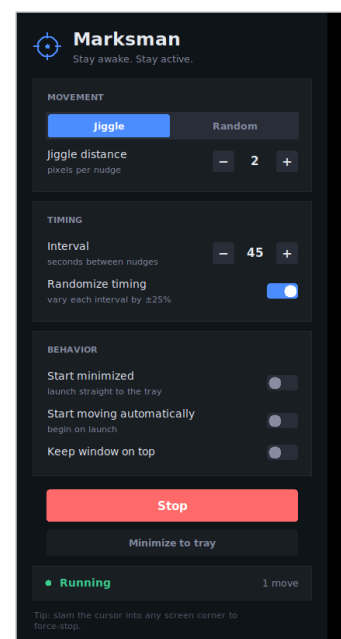
Seconds between each nudge. 45 is a sensible setting. Anything under a minute does the job.

Getting it out of the way

Press **Minimize to tray** and the window disappears but keeps working. To bring it back, look at the bottom-right of your screen, click the small ^ arrow to show hidden icons, and right-click the crosshair for Start, Stop and Quit. Closing the window with the X also just hides it.

Stopping it in a hurry

Shove the mouse pointer hard into any corner of the screen. Marksman stops on the spot.



Marksman while it's running.

Making it automatic

Switch on **Start minimized** and **Start moving automatically**. From then on, opening Marksman sends it straight to the tray already working, with no window and nothing to click.

PART THREE / IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

"The publisher could not be verified"

Click **Run**. To stop it asking every time, close Marksman and go back and do the Unblock step from step 2 on the files you downloaded.

I double-clicked Marksman and nothing happened

It has probably started. Marksman is built to open quietly, so there's no window on first launch if you've set it to start minimized. Check the bottom-right of your screen, click the small ^ arrow, and look for the crosshair icon.

Setup says it can't find Python

The Marksman folder isn't where it needs to be. Go back to step 6. The folder holding Setup.bat has to sit alongside the python folder, not somewhere else on your PC.

My files show as "Text Document" instead of the right type

Windows is hiding file extensions, which makes it easy to save a file under the wrong name. In any folder window, open the **View** menu and switch on **File name extensions**, then check the names again.

My PC still goes to sleep

Check the bottom of the Marksman window actually says **Running** in green. Marksman only holds the machine awake while it's running, so if you pressed Stop or quit it, your normal sleep settings take over again.

Marksman is free and open source, and the code is on the GitHub page in step 4. If you get stuck, take a photo of your screen and send it to whoever passed this guide on to you. It's nearly always one of the five things above.